chawanmushi

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Chawanmushi, a savory Japanese egg custard. Silky and comforting. Enjoy it for breakfast or maybe a midday snack. Very easy and tasty. For best results, I suggest using cold dashi. Throw all your dashi ingredients in a quart and put in the fridge over night works just as well. You can also substitute with pre-made dashi if you'd like.

Recipe:

Serves: 2-3

Time: ~45 minutes

Ingredients:

Dashi:

- 16 oz water
- 1 oz kombu (4x6in piece)
- 3 caps dried shiitake mushrooms
- 3 Tbsp soy sauce
- 1 Tbsp mirin
- 1 Tbsp sake
- 1 lion's mane mushroom, optional
- 2 Tbsp bonito flakes
- Kosher salt, to taste

Chawanmushi:

- 2 large eggs
- 1 1/3 cup dashi
- Seared oyster mushrooms, for serving
- Poached lion's mane mushroom, for serving
- Salmon roe, for serving
- Sliced chives, for garnish

Method:

1. For the dashi- In a small sauce pot combine all ingredients except bonito flakes. Simmer on low for about 30 minutes. Remove lion's mane mushrooms, if using. Turn off heat and add in bonito flakes. Let sit for 10 minutes. Strain through a fine mesh strainer.
2. Place in refrigerator overnight or if using right away, let it come to room temperature or cooler.
3. Season dashi with salt to taste.

For Chawanmushi:

1. Set up a steamer over medium low heat.
2. Using a blender, mix eggs with dashi. Strain through fine mesh strainer. Remove air bubbles with torch.
3. In your desired serving bowl, place your sliced poached lion's mane mushroom(if using) on the bottom and pour in egg mixture. You can probably get 3 - 1/2 cup portions.
4. Steam over medium-low heat for 12-15 minutes until middle is set but still jiggly.
5. Top with seared oyster mushrooms, salmon roe and garnish with sliced chives.

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